



## Are You In Suspense?

**Are you wondering what happened to your order or payment, even after a fortnight? But did you mention your name and address clearly while sending payment, and what the payment was for?**

We get several payments every month without adequate instructions or even identity of the person sending the payment. As a result we are unable to take appropriate action on these, till we get a complaint - if at all.

At EFY, we want you to be our satisfied customer. So please do let us know in case your payment or instructions are not even acknowledged within a fortnight. We are not that lazy!

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described as follows: First, YES Bank Ltd (YBL) shares the customer's details including his account balance for the day. Following this, the business correspondent agent (BC agent) enters his login request through the mobile device. On successful BC login, the customer is asked to provide his debit card to swipe through the card slot in the Bluetooth printer. A debit card validation request is sent to the UPASS server. Upon successful validation, one-time password (OTP) and withdrawal details are sent to the customer's registered mobile number. Else, an error message is displayed on the mobile screen.

OTPs are used because these are invulnerable to the drawbacks of static passwords where a hacker can make use of the password to access the account. This is of high significance in a rural setting where the users might not be tech savvy to understand the importance of keeping a password secure.

The OTP generated is shared with the BC agent and entered through the mobile device. Next, the OTP validation request is sent to UPASS backend server. After successful validation, the amount to be withdrawn is entered through the mobile device, and the mapping and validation are done at the UPASS backend server.

Finally, a transaction receipt command is sent to the mobile device. The receipt is printed through the thermal printer, and the cash as well as transaction receipt are handed over to the customer. The transaction is concluded with a confirmation SMS sent to the customer, and End of Day data is shared by the BC with YES Bank for the customer's account update.

### Some obstacles

The team faced its share of difficulties while creating such an innovative solution.

Vaibhav Peshney, regional financial inclusion leader, YES Bank, shares some of the challenges, "The major challenge was to develop the system from a normal collection device to a

mobile banking product. Customisation of the back-end servers and the front-end interface was a major task. Even for some of us who had been working in this sector for a considerable number of years, understanding the exact need of the target customer was again a challenge. In fact, these challenges only pushed us to think frugal and come up with our very own Frugal Innovation for Financial Inclusion (FI4FI) programme; YES Sahaj is one such innovation under this initiative."

Rupesh Kumar, financial inclusion leader, adds, "For the initial workable collection module, it took only four months time for a basic product as cable collection device to be in place. The credit goes to both the teams for their dedicated efforts. We had to customise the product for banking requirements and standards and then train their back-end team to deal with the banking standards. After that, it has been continuous research and development which has helped in adding new features from time to time."

### Future expansion plans

Financial inclusion is an evolving sector. Customising the product to the needs of the customers is a learning experience for all the players in this field. Amulya Bisht, associate, cites the example of YES Sahaj micro ATM, "YES Bank itself has gone through many phases of development to come out from a mere field collection device to a withdrawal and deposit platform and now to a complete doorstep micro-ATM-cum-teller. In coming days, many new features, including a more secure transaction mode, along with product customisation to address other standard banking products like overdraft facility, will be added to it."

The standalone services for micro ATM will be charged on a per-transaction basis. This amount will be very small as compared to the wage loss incurred by customers in visiting the banking premises. ●

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